

NUTRITION IN ADULTHOOD AND OLD AGE

CHAPTER 4

OBJECTIVES

This chapter briefly discuss about:-

- Nutrient requirement of adult and elderly people,
- Factors affecting the intake of food among elderly,
- Modification of diet during old age,
- Major nutrition related problems among elderly.

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Man needs a wide range of nutrients which performs various functions in the body. During adulthood nitrients are needed for energy , replacement of worn out tissues and maintenance of body function. Though there is no growth during adulthood , protein is required for the replacement of worn out tissues. Individuals are known to age at different rates. Ageing is not a disease but a biological process. It is a normal process begins at conception and ends only with death. The changes are associated with ageing are partly influenced by genetics, race and gender. Heredity and good nutrition may slow the ageing process so that the individual enjoys physical and mental vigour in his eighties. Goal of nutritional care should be to help the aged achieve to a healthy, purposeful and independent living.

4.1 Adult

People belonging to 18 to 40 years of age are called adults.

Reference Indian adult man and woman

Reference man is between 18 - 29 years of age and weighs 60 kg with a height of 1.73 m with a BMI of 20.3 and is free from disease and physically fit for active work. Reference woman is between 18-29 years of age, non-pregnant and non lactating (NPNL) and weighs 55 kg with a height of 1.61 m and a B.M.I of 21.2, is free from disease and physically fit for active work.

4.1.1 Nutrient requirement of adults

a) Energy

Nutrient requirements of an adult man and woman are based on reference man and reference woman. Important factor which determine the energy need is the nature and duration of physical activity whether moderate or heavy. For those whose occupation entails heavy work, allowances have to be higher than for those who are sedentary or engaged in moderate work

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